



Gerard Barrera Peñas

Judge – 72nd cohort, Spanish Judicial School – g.barrera@poderjudicial.es

Profile

Career judge with specialised technical training in programming and artificial intelligence applied to the judiciary. Developer of software tools for judicial automation and case management, awarded by the General Council of the Judiciary. Research, teaching and outreach activity, reflected in legal publications and in the direction of training conferences.

Experience

Feb 2024 – present	Judge Seat no. 2, Criminal Division, Tarragona Trial Court.
Jun 2024 – present	Tutor for the competitive examinations for the Judiciary and Public Prosecution Service Self-employed.
Jul 2023 – Feb 2024	Substitute and support judge Court of First Instance and Investigation no. 2 of Almuñécar and Court for Violence against Women.
Dec 2022 – Jul 2023	Assistant judge Investigating Court no. 1 and Court of First Instance no. 1 of Granada.
Jan 2022 – Dec 2022	Trainee judge Spanish Judicial School, General Council of the Judiciary.

Projects

Sept 2026 – present	Criminal jurisdiction tool suite Integration of the tools into a suite with its own launcher that centralises installation, opening and updating, and a shared court configuration. Distribution through a public GitHub repository with versioned releases, automatic updates verified by cryptographic hash, and a user notification channel.
Jul 2026	Non-appearance sanctions tool Handles fines imposed on witnesses or expert witnesses who fail to appear: generates the sanctioning decision, the order opening a separate proceeding and, where appropriate, the order to bring the person before the court.

Feb 2026 – May 2026	Custodial status decisions tool Drafting of orders for pre-trial detention and release in cases of non-appearance, confirmation of detention, arrest warrants and the hearing under Article 505 of the Criminal Procedure Act (LECrim).
Dec 2025 – present	Justicia en Código blog Outreach initiative exploring the convergence between judicial work and programming, through the justiciaencodigo.com blog and the @juezprogramador channel on X: open-source software, technical analysis and tutorials aimed at modernising the judiciary.
Jul 2025 – Dec 2025	Sentence enforcement tool Processes and analyses criminal record sheets, issues detailed reports on whether records can be expunged, and assists in drafting procedural decisions on enforcement.
Aug 2025	Hearing duration calculator Estimates the length of scheduled hearings according to the criteria agreed by the Tarragona Criminal Judges' Board, with configurable custom criteria and additional circumstances.
Mar 2024 – Jul 2025	Plea agreement tool (Awarded by the CGPJ) Automates the drafting of judgments based on plea agreements and related decisions.

Awards

Nov 2025	Judicial Innovation and Efficiency Award Asociación Judicial Francisco de Vitoria (judges' association).
May 2025	Quality of Justice Awards – More Effective Justice (12th edition) General Council of the Judiciary (CGPJ).

Talks and courses

21–23 Sept 2026	Artificial intelligence from a threefold perspective: technical, legal and practical Coordinator and speaker. Centre for Legal Studies and Specialised Training of Catalonia (CEJFE).
7–10 Jul 2026	Critical evaluation of AI-generated outputs Speaker. Judiciary Summer School on Artificial Intelligence (CGPJ).
6 Jul 2026	Introduction to AI for teaching staff Coordinator and speaker. Spanish Judicial School (CGPJ), Training Plan for CGPJ staff.

7–8 May 2026	Beyond generative AI: traditional programming as a driver of efficiency in judicial work Paper. 11th Processulus, Conference of Young Researchers in Procedural Law, Faculty of Law, University of Granada (UGR).
29 Apr 2026	Admission and assessment of electronic evidence Speaker. ICAT conference on digital evidence in criminal proceedings, Tarragona Bar Association.
12–13 Mar 2026	Classical programming versus artificial intelligence models: structural differences and practical applications in the judiciary Speaker. Tarragona Conference on Artificial Intelligence.
24 Oct 2025	The judge in the age of artificial intelligence: independence and technology Speaker. Procedural Law Research Group seminar, Faculty of Law, Pompeu Fabra University (UPF).

Publications

2026	Más allá de la IA generativa: la programación tradicional como motor de la eficiencia en el ejercicio de la labor jurisdiccional <i>Atelier</i> (in press).
2026	Proposición, admisión y valoración de la prueba electrónica en el proceso penal <i>Justicia: Revista de Derecho Procesal</i> , Bosch Editor, no. 1, pp. 403–439.
2024	La posesión y los derechos reales: análisis jurisprudencial In <i>El Derecho Civil catalán desde la jurisprudencia y la práctica judicial</i> , Atelier, pp. 619–635.

Certifications and technical training

In progress	Getting Started with Artificial Intelligence Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (UOC).
Sept 2026	AI, Justice, and the Rule of Law University of Oxford and UNESCO.
Sept 2026	Python for Programmers Codecademy.
Jun 2026	Generative AI: Prompt Engineering Basics IBM.
Nov 2025	Prompting Fundamentals for AI I and II Google.
Nov 2025	Introduction to Artificial Intelligence IBM.
Nov 2025	Elements of AI University of Helsinki.
Nov 2025	Python Programming Essentials Rice University.
Oct 2025	AI in Society: AI and Justice University of Helsinki.
Oct 2025	AI in Society: Introduction University of Helsinki.

Education

2021 – 2023	Master's Degree in the Exercise of the Judicial Function National University of Distance Education (UNED).
2022 – 2023	Postgraduate Diploma in Catalan Civil Law University of Barcelona (UB).
Mar 2019 – Sept 2021	Candidate in the competitive examinations for the Judiciary and Public Prosecution Service Passed in the 2020 examination round.
2013 – 2019	Double Degree in Law and in Political Science and Public Administration Autonomous University of Barcelona (UAB).

Languages

Spanish native. **Catalan** native. **English** upper-intermediate. **French** basic.